cantaloupe

Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

Employee: Hemanth Kota
Job Title: Software Architect
Department: Engineering
Issuing Manager: Vinay Srinivasan, Director of Software Development
HR Representative: Alyssa Braniecki, VP People Operations
Date of Discussion: 04/17/2026
PIP Duration: 30 Days

Purpose of This Performance Improvement Plan
The purpose of this Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is to clearly outline areas requiring improvement, define expectations going forward, and provide Hemanth with the opportunity to demonstrate sustained improvement within a defined timeframe. Failure to meet these expectations may result in further corrective action, up to and including termination.

Summary of Performance Concerns
Based on *recent* discussions on March 12, 2026 March 31, 2026 April 2,2026 April 14,2026 concerns have been identified in communication transparency, task ownership, independent execution, and proactive planning. While effort has been observed, improvement has not been consistent or sufficient.

Performance Areas of Concern

1. Communication Transparency and Visibility
Examples include limited visibility into AXIS upgrade progress, insufficient stand-up status updates (03/31), lack of stakeholder communication regarding shelving DMS and moving to Seedlive, and unauthorized customer communication. There were multiple instances where conversation is being had by you directly with the stakeholder without keeping your manager and concerned team members updated of the same, in addition there were slippages in delivery schedule and quality of the fix is not met as per the SLA. Has not demonstrated ability to build a roadmap or future tasks.

Expectation: Provide timely, clear updates and ensure relevant stakeholders are included.
Measurement: Improved status reporting and documented communications.

2. Accountability for Task Completion
Examples include lack of task completion ownership, deletion of long-open PRs without resolution (03/12), diversion into non-related issues, and limited measurable progress on AXIS upgrade (03/31). Not open to ideas and pushback on relevant review comments is observed. Multiple instances of you not following through agreed upon terms during the implementation from the peers has been brought up.

Expectation: Drive assigned tasks to completion within expected timeframes. Build relevant tasks to showcase ability to follow thru with agreed upon deliverable with maintaining quality
Measurement: Completed deliverables and adherence to timelines with JIRA tickets updated accordingly and sign off from peer reviews

3. Independent Ownership and Execution
Examples include continued dependency on others to progress tasks despite repeated discussions (03/12), partial improvement with ongoing gaps noted (03/31).
Not being a self-starter is a major roadblock. It has been over 8 months, and team does not see signs on contributing to the overall team goals in a progressive way, need to be solution oriented instead of tagging in as an entry level dev.

Examples include limited visibility into AXIS upgrade progress, insufficient stand-up status updates (03/3: stakeholder communication regarding shelving DMS and moving to Seedlive, and unauthorized customer communication. There were multiple instances where conversation is being had by you directly with the stakeholder without keeping manager and concerned team members updated of the same, in addition there were slippages in delivery schedule quality of the fix is not met as per the SLA. Has not demonstrated ability to build a roadmap or future tasks.
Expectation: Provide timely, clear updates and ensure relevant stakeholders are included.
Measurement: Improved status reporting and documented communications.

First of this sentence has grammatical mistakes and old without updating of work completed for seedlive along with first data, portico posgateways, keymanger. Total 4 presentations were given to all stake holders apart from daily stand unprofessional debates. SLA is to mitigate and address High VeraCode Axis 1 CVE vulnerabilities. This was communicated in two recorded presentations to all stakeholders including low level interns.

Expectation : Customer resolution cannot be unauthorized here in EPort server team. Multiple customer concerns (in a long history) were resolved in last 10 years involving Amy Seymour. CEO Mr Ravi Venkatesan himself in Malvern social setting(March 12) said resolving customer pain points is the leadership priority. Nowhere in the last 8 months did product owner raised concern either in written policy form or verbal form flagged it with all stakeholders. What does Director of Engineering has to do with customer email thread? Instead the director responsibilities is to heed to scrum master, product managers and establish customer long standing pain points, establish mitigating mechanism like Embedded Team does with InternalOutages slack channel. Vinay is looped in email chain but customer(MCR hotels) didn't include him in future requests (1/16/2026).

Examples include lack of task completion ownership, deletion of long-open PRs without resolution (03/12), diversion into non-related issues, and limited measurable progresso AXIS upgrade (03/31). Not open toideas and pushback on relevant review comments is observed. Multiple instances of you not following through agreed upon terms during the implementation from the peers has been brought up

**This concern is in direct contradiction with below Independent Ownership. First thing is open team run PR isn't conducted since 2024. PR is closed process lately in our team.
I have created value by raising red flags with PR process multiple times since 7 Jan 2026. For JIRA: USAT-16377 concern with the solution shipped to CSC was discussed with all product owners where Darren and Dmitriy pushed back based on my recommendations.
Happy to provide multiple evidence. The real question: Isn't Executing terms expected from product people as well?**

cantaloupe

Expectation: Demonstrate independent leadership and reduced reliance on others. Be solution oriented, develop extensive skill on design and documentation
Measurement: Increased autonomy and task ownership.

4. Initiative in Planning and Handoffs
Examples include limited upfront analysis of AXIS requirements (03/12), failure to deliver task-matrix visibility as discussed (03/31), and incomplete documentation handoffs. Inability to provide solid documentation to consumer as in the example of CSC was a major setback on the project, had to bring in more help to wrap up the SOW.

Expectation: Proactively assess requirements and maintain clear documentation and handoffs. Get better industry standard design and other documentation along with handoff documents as needed
Measurement: Delivery of planning artifacts and improved team clarity with well-written documentation

Support and Check-ins
Weekly check-ins will be held to review progress. HR may participate as needed.

Consequences of Failing to Perform
If acceptable performance is not achieved and sustained, additional corrective action may occur, up to and including termination.

Employee Acknowledgement

I acknowledge receipt of this Performance Improvement Plan. My signature does not indicate agreement.

Employee Signature: _____ **Date:** __04/17/2026_____

Manager Signature: _____ **Date:** ___04/17/2026_____

HR Signature: _____ **Date:** ___04/17/2026_____

Examples include continued dependency on others to progress tasks despite repeated discussions (03/12), partial improvement with on going gaps noted(03/31)
Not being a self-starter is a major roadblock. It has been over 8 months, and team does not see signs on contributing to the overall team goals in a progressive way, need to be solution oriented instead of tagging in as an entry level dev.

We have entry level developers in India only and no way its possible due to time differences. Resolved Independently AWS SSH, S3 concerns on Sept 3rd, 2025, Dec 12, 2025, Jan 28, April 10 2026 etc. involving Embedded and senior Cantaloupe Developers and even SVP of various teams.

Examples include limited upfront analysis of AXIS requirements03/12), failure to deliver task-matrix visibility as discussec (03/31), and incomplete documentation handoffs. Inability to provide solid documentation to consumeras in the example of CSC was a major setback on the project, had to bring in more help to wrap up the SOw.

Shouldn't senior product ePort owners priority is Revenue creation projects like UBC, CheckOut instead of flagging money costing projects like Axis 1 without proper customer impact analysis. Documentation can't be a tool of accomplishment even though it was updated again and again. Major client affecting projects have no proper documentation since 2005 and they should be prioritized for Aramark, Atrium. CSC was provided with documentation(CTLP_DEVICE_RESTAPI_v2.pdf) and postman collection resolution from Jan 9th to Jan 13th 2026. Repeating that it's never bought in previous 1-1. Concerns are with work done by Senior Software Engineer work on USAT15259 which predated my joining as observed by QA. Evidence shall be provided to CTO, SVP if necessary

I strongly request the HR participating on Thursday 1-1 with Manager to Check-Ins. And to go through the evidence provided and involve necessary senior product owners if needed from other teams(more than 10 years). Again I repeat the narrative can't be shifting apart from above 4 concerns. Even now I don't get emails either from SVP or HR team about company. Old concerns can't be pinned on new owners. I havn't received and written termination policy neither at joining nor in my 1 week of Performance Improvement Plan. Kindly review and request evidence with whole context in picture.

P.S.: I shall reject any 1-1 verbal narriative and will not be taken/accepted as termination reason going ahead without HR participation.

Because I know my compensation is less than a truck driver in USA. I am in Cantaloupe because the payments business is in renaissance with old players like Fiserv, PayPal crashing with prospect of market capture by new players like US and Toast.